PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

March 8, 2026
Board Retreat

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Board Retreat of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:

Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia LaForte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan; and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Absent: Student Representative Ian Ritorto

Facilitators:
Amy Cast – Bombastic Communications
Sandy Hayes – Bombastic Communications

Non-Participating Attendees:
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant; Board Clerk
Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education

Call to Order and Introductions

The Meeting was called to order at 9:15 am by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Retreat

Time: 9:16 am

The Board and Superintendent participated in introductory activities and reviewed the meeting agenda. Facilitators lead the Board and Superintendent through discussion on how to better structure Board meeting discussions, including establishing consistent participation practices, clarifying when and how questions should be asked, and identifying the Superintendent as the primary point of contact for clarifying questions during a meeting. The Board agreed to consider revising their operating agreements to reflect updated practices at a later date.

Break: 10:35 – 10:38 am

Facilitators summarized prior retreat themes and introduced concepts related to trust and governance. Board members discussed their role in fostering public trust, balancing accountability with maintaining confidence in the district, and identified effective meeting structures and communication practices. The Board's role as a bridge between the district and the community was emphasized, along with the importance of transparency and accessibility, including considerations related to public comment and sharing information with the public.

Lunch Break: 11:56 am – 12:17 pm

There was discussion focused on maintaining a future-oriented approach and strengthening collaboration among Board members. Strategies were shared for staying focused on outcomes, supporting one another's effectiveness, and engaging in productive dialogue. There was initial discussion on improving communication practices with staff, including clarifying expectations for information requests and aligning processes to support efficiency and transparency.

Break 12:56 pm – 1:06 pm

The Board continued discussion on communication and information request processes, considering structured approaches for submitting and tracking requests, including prioritization, timelines, and expectations. Emphasis was placed on ensuring efficient responses while respecting staff capacity. Board members also discussed coordination in responding to community communications, with a focus on consistency, transparency, and reducing duplication of efforts.

Adjourn

The retreat was adjourned at 2:40 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools